

Binder

The **evidence layer** for regulated inspections

By Baden Bagley — April 2026

THE VISION

Every inspection report becomes evidence a regulator, insurer, or lender can trust — without a human re-reading it.

Binder turns inspection PDFs into auditable, compliance-ready findings. Eight templates in. One defensible record out.

WHO WE SERVE

The Buyer Who Gets Blamed

Primary: VP of Operations or Head of Compliance at mid-market home inspection services firms — 50 to 500 inspectors, multi-state coverage, ASHI/InterNACHI-derived templates.

Adjacent: Insurance carriers and mortgage underwriters who consume inspection PDFs as a compliance input and need 7-year auditable evidence.

The person who gets blamed when a finding is missed, disputed, or legally challenged — and has no defensible audit trail today.

THE PROBLEM

Three Ways a Finding Gets Lost

- **Financial:** \$180K–\$400K/year burned on manual extraction, reviewer QA, and per-template parser builds. Cloud OCR adds \$2–\$4 per report before a reviewer opens it.
- **Operational:** Eight templates = eight brittle integrations. Findings get lost between PDFs, photos, and reviewer judgment.
- **Personal:** Compliance leads ship audit bundles they cannot fully defend. When a claim is disputed, nobody can reproduce the decision.

Today, the evidence trail behind a finding lives in a reviewer's head.

\$2-\$4

per report in cloud OCR cost — before a human
reviewer opens it

Binder's PyMuPDF-first extraction: \$0 marginal on digital PDFs

Problem → Solution, one-to-one

What breaks today

- Per-template parser work
- Reviewer memory as evidence
- OCR cost wall at scale
- Audit bundles that can't be defended

How Binder fixes it

- Deterministic PyMuPDF across 8 templates
- Every finding linked to page, photo, ROI, verdict, timestamp
- \$0 marginal cost on digital PDFs
- 7-year WORM retention, CloudTrail, KMS — native

ARCHITECTURE

AWS-Native, Serverless, Production-Live

```
S3 → EventBridge → Step Functions → PyMuPDF  
→ ERIC Review UI → DynamoDB → Receipts (Object Lock)
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SLOs already enforced: PDF validation $\geq 99\%$ rolling 24h · p99 latency $\leq 30s$ · DLQ = 0 · Lambda error rate $\leq 1\%$

Governance shipping: CodeDeploy gradual rollout (10% / 1min, auto-rollback) · SHA256 artifact signing · KMS encryption · EventBridge 90-day replay archive

COMMERCIAL MODEL

Pricing That Fits the Buyer

TIER	PRICE	TARGET
Starter	\$1,500/mo	<500 reports/mo, 1–3 reviewers
Growth	\$5,000/mo + \$0.50/report over 2,500	2,500–10,000 reports/mo
Enterprise	Custom (\$120K+ ACV)	10K+ reports, multi-tenant, SSO

- **80%+ gross margin target** — serverless cost floor scales down sharply with volume
- **12-month CAC payback (est.)** — mid-market SaaS benchmark
- **\$36K blended ACV (est.)**

Pricing draft — pending Baden's input on pilot conversations and anchor economics.

\$720M

SAM — mid-market US inspection firms + top 500
insurance/lending consumers

Bottom-up; TAM \$2.2B, SOM 3% over 36 months = \$22M ARR

MARKET ANALYSIS

Bottom-Up, Not Wishful

LAYER	LOGIC	SIZE
TAM	~120K US home inspection firms × \$18K avg spend + 10K carriers/underwriters	\$2.2B
SAM	~8K mid-market firms (50+ inspectors) + top 500 compliance buyers	\$720M
SOM	3% capture over 36 months	\$22M ARR

Estimates — to be validated with ASHI/InterNACHI and analyst data before raise.

MARKET VIABILITY

The Tailwinds Are Already Blowing

- **Regulatory pull:** Insurance/lending compliance already requires 7-year retention. State-level insurance AI transparency rules (CA, CO, NY, 2026–2028) raise the evidence bar further.
- **Behavioral shift:** Industry moved from PDF.js + custom parsers to managed AWS services (Binder itself is that migration, shipped).
- **Competition validates the market:** Textract, Google Document AI, Hyperscience, HomeGauge, ISN — all solve **adjacent** pieces. None deliver evidence-linked, template-normalized, compliance-ready bundles.

8,110

validated findings already in production

46-51 findings per report across three golden fixtures • 66
reviewer verdicts recorded

EVIDENCE OF SUCCESS

The Foundation Is Shipped

Technical maturity (hard numbers):

- **v3.3 live** on AWS · **v2.3** launched with CodeDeploy canary + auto-rollback
- **51 of 81** production readiness items complete · **9 of 10** UI acceptance gates pass
- **SDK v2.4.0**: 7 reusable business-logic modules, zero breaking changes
- **EventBridge 90-day replay** — ML reprocessing without re-extracting from PDFs
- **8,110 findings** validated in DynamoDB; 66 verdicts; 43-item review queue active

Commercial: Internal validation by ERIC (inspector) + FRAN (TPM/compliance). **Design-partner conversions are the Q3 milestone this raise funds.**

FUTURE GROWTH

3-Year Trajectory

YEAR	ARR	INFLECTION
Y1 (2026)	\$400K	3 design-partner conversions + 2 paid pilots
Y2 (2027)	\$2.2M	Enterprise tier launch; 2 carrier integrations; 15+ templates
Y3 (2028)	\$7.5M	Multi-tenant SaaS; lending/insurance SDK; 90%+ auto-resolve

- Gross margin expands **72% → 85%** as infrastructure amortizes
- Break-even ~**\$3.5M ARR (est.)** mid-Y2
- **First carrier integration unlocks \$500K+ ACV enterprise deals**

UNIQUE ADVANTAGE

Four Moats, Compounding

1. **The codebook grows with every review.** 8,110+ verdicts already feed confidence calibration competitors can't replicate without operating at scale for years.
2. **Template fingerprinting across 8 standards.** Proprietary section-alias map (30 aliases → 12 canonical systems). Generic document-AI tools can't do this without domain-specific training.
3. **Evidence-linked provenance by design.** Every finding → page, photo, ROI, verdict, SHA256-signed artifact. Retrofitting this into Textract deployments is a multi-quarter rebuild.
4. **Regulatory switching cost.** Once a carrier or lender certifies their compliance workflow on Binder's audit bundles, moving off means re-certifying the audit trail.

Not moats: "AWS-native," "serverless," "better UX." Any well-funded team can copy those.

Operational → Adjacent → Category

H1 (0–12 mo, Now)

- Ship Phase 2–5 (SDK refactor, codebook resolver)
- 8 templates in prod
- 90% DDID coverage / DHI
- Convert 2–3 paid pilots
- Close final 30 readiness items

H2 (12–24 mo)

- 15+ templates
- Photo-level CV analysis
- First carrier + underwriter integrations
- Multi-tenant SaaS, SSO
- 70%+ auto-resolve, <2s p99

THE TEAM

Built by Operators, For Operators

- **Baden Bagley — Founder & CEO.** Built Binder from first commit to v3.3 production. Operates the full AWS-native stack (CDK, Step Functions, Lambda layers, EventBridge, CodeDeploy) as founding engineer. Deep inspection-industry context via Spector.
- **Eric — Domain Lead (Inspector).** Field-grade inspection expertise. Codebook corrections train Binder's confidence model — the validation loop is internal.
- **Fran — TPM / Compliance.** Release gating, QA verification, audit bundle signoff. Runs nightly audits and quarterly compliance reports.
- **Brady Smallwood — Strategic Advisor.** Former COO and board member. Chicago Booth MBA. 16+ years finance, analytics, retail ops, foodservice. Advising on commercial positioning, pricing, GTM, and investor narrative.

Advisors, key hires, and compliance counsel — to be added post-raise.

The evidence layer for regulated inspections is **being built now.**

The foundation is live. The codebook is growing. The next 12 months turn it into a business.

mception.ai/baden-bagley